

Analytical & Writing Sample Portfolio

Dropout prevention and educational persistence policies in Gironde (2025) — France

Report Research Consultant application

Francisco Martin-Gomez · July 2025

This portfolio presents excerpts from an internal report produced for local education authorities (DASEN 33 and the Bordeaux Regional Education Authority — restricted distribution¹), intended to demonstrate analytical and editorial writing skills across a range of institutional formats. The underlying report draws on original administrative monitoring data (Gironde, France, academic year 2024–25) as well as national and international evidence ; its mandate covered both a review of departmental dropout prevention policies and a compliance assessment against international frameworks (SDG 4, UNESCO Education 2030). The portfolio illustrates competencies across several common institutional report output formats: key messages, analytical chapter text, analytical boxes, profile sections, legal framework crosswalk and indicator mapping. Two original indicators were developed from existing administrative data, derived without additional data collection and proposed as operational monitoring tools for sub-national early school leaving systems. All figures were produced from primary administrative data. Data scope: MEN (Ministère de l'Éducation Nationale) institutions, Gironde département (~93% of the full identified early school leaving caseload).

Contents

- I.** Key messages & key figures
- II.** Chapter text — Early warning systems and dropout prevention
- III.** Analytical box — Early identification and re-engagement limits
- IV.** Profile extract — France: early school leaving prevention
- V.** Box — National frameworks and SDG 4: a crosswalk (France)
- VI.** Box — Methodological note: the continuity of follow-up indicator
- VII.** Supporting data and figures
- VIII.** SDG indicator mapping

¹Martin-Gomez, F. (2025). *Politiques de prévention du décrochage scolaire et persévérance éducative dans les collèges et lycées de la Gironde* [Restricted-circulation internal report, under the coordination of L. Meguenine]. Bordeaux Education Authority and the Departmental Directorate of National Education Services of Gironde (DASEN 33).

I. Key Messages

Dropout prevention and educational persistence policies — France and Gironde, 2024–25

- 01** France has reduced its early school leaving rate from 11.3% in 2010 to 7.6% in 2023, meeting the EU benchmark of below 9%, yet approximately 76,000 young people still leave education each year without a qualification — and approximately 3.1 million do so across the European Union (DEPP, 2024; Eurostat, 2024). Progress has been uneven across population groups, with young men leaving at significantly higher rates than young women (EU: 10.9% vs 7.7%) and vocational track students facing disproportionate risk.
- 02** Monthly tracking data from Gironde reveal a structural bifurcation in dropout profiles: approximately one quarter of newly identified cases in October 2024 resolved within one month — consistent with students who failed to re-enrol at the start of the academic year and reconnected quickly once contacted. From February 2025, the monthly exit rate fell below 2.4% and stabilised near 1% by June, indicating that students who remain in the system beyond the initial re-entry window represent significantly more complex cases for whom spontaneous resolution is rare (Lyche, 2010).
- 03** Against a caseload of 4,542 identified young people in June 2025 — 95.3% of whom had not attained any qualification at Level V (CAP/BEP equivalent) — MLDS re-engagement services reached only 3.5% of the identified population. Active accompaniment plateaued at approximately 130–160 cases from January onward, consistent with a staffing-capacity ceiling rather than declining demand. This gap between detection capacity and intervention reach is a central challenge for SDG 4.4 and SDG 8.6 monitoring.
- 04** France's legal and institutional framework for dropout prevention — combining compulsory participation for 16–18-year-olds, the right to return to education or training, and multi-actor coordination platforms (PSAD, MLDS, Missions Locales) — is broadly aligned with SDG 4 commitments on completion, equity and lifelong learning. However, alignment depends on operational effectiveness: consistent monitoring indicators, timely identification, and sustained referral chains rather than legal compliance alone.

Key figures — Gironde dropout monitoring system (MEN), 2024–25

4,542 Active cases (June 2025) <i>MEN caseload identified</i>	+17.2% Growth over academic year <i>Sept 2024 → June 2025</i>	3.5% MLDS support reach <i>159 active / 4,542 identified</i>
99% Continuity rate (June) <i>cases carried over month-to-month</i>	95.3% Without Level V qual. <i>4,327 of 4,542 (June 2025)</i>	60.9% Male share of stock <i>vs 39.1% female (June 2025)</i>

II. Chapter Text · ~520 words

Early warning systems and dropout prevention: detection capacity versus intervention reach

Reducing school dropout requires not only identifying students at risk, but ensuring that identification translates into sustained support. Despite progress — France reduced its early school leaving rate from 11.3% in 2010 to 7.6% in 2023 (DEPP, 2024; Eurostat, 2024), tracking towards the EU's 2030 target of below 9% — around 76,000 young people still leave French education annually without a qualification, and approximately 3.1 million do so across the European Union (Eurostat, 2024).

Monthly administrative data from Gironde's dropout tracking system offer a rare window into the infra-annual dynamics of re-engagement. Over the 2024–25 academic year, the active MEN caseload grew from 3,874 in September 2024 to 4,542 by June 2025 — a net increase of 668 identified young people (+17.2%) despite 2,652 recorded exits from the monitoring system. Critically, 95.3% of the June caseload comprised young people without any Level V qualification (CAP/BEP equivalent), placing them at heightened risk of long-term exclusion from both education and employment pathways — a direct concern for SDG 4.4 and SDG 8.6 monitoring. This divergence between detection and resolution is a central policy challenge highlighted across international monitoring frameworks (European Commission, 2013).

The data reveal a structural bifurcation in dropout profiles with direct implications for intervention design. In October 2024, approximately one quarter (24.0%) of the prior month's caseload exited the system — consistent with students who failed to re-enrol at the start of the academic year and reconnected quickly once contacted. From February 2025 onward, however, the monthly exit rate fell below 2.4% and continued declining to 1.0% by June. This suggests that students who remain in the system beyond the initial re-entry window represent significantly more complex cases, for whom spontaneous resolution is rare and targeted support is essential (Lyche, 2010). The shifting establishment profile further illustrates this stratification: the share of vocational upper secondary (LP) students in the caseload grew from 44.6% in September to 50.9% in June, while the general track (LGT) share declined from 43.3% to 27.9%, consistent with evidence on higher dropout risk in vocational pathways (DEPP, 2025).

Against this backdrop, the capacity of MLDS services to provide active support remained severely constrained. Active accompaniment plateaued at approximately 130–160 cases from January onward — consistent with a staffing-capacity ceiling — reaching only 3.5% of the identified caseload by June. The gender composition of the stock (60.9% male, 39.1% female) is broadly consistent with European patterns of male over-representation in early school leaving (Eurostat, 2024), while females were marginally under-represented in MLDS support relative to their share of the stock (36.5% vs 39.1%), a pattern warranting further investigation in light of evidence on the relative invisibility of female dropout trajectories.

These findings illustrate a broader challenge for SDG 4 monitoring: completion rate indicators (SDG 4.1.2) capture educational outcomes at a single point in time, but infra-annual tracking data reveal the process through which non-completion accumulates — and the persistent gap between identification capacity and intervention reach. Strengthening dropout prevention in line with SDG 4 and SDG 8.6 commitments requires not only improved early warning mechanisms, but substantial investment in re-engagement services that translate identification into sustained educational participation.

III. Analytical Box · ~160 words

BOX · Early identification and the limits of re-engagement: evidence from Gironde

School dropout is rarely abrupt. In France, 7% of secondary pupils were absent without justification on at least four half-days per month in 2023–24 — rising to 17% in vocational upper secondary schools (DEPP, 2025) — reflecting a broader evidence base showing that dropout is typically preceded by observable risk signals appearing years before students leave the system (Lyche, 2010; UNICEF, 2018). Monthly tracking data from Gironde's multi-agency dropout monitoring system illustrate both the reach and the limits of early identification mechanisms. By June 2025, 4,542 young people within MEN institutions were actively tracked — a 17% increase on the September 2024 baseline — yet active support from MLDS services reached only 3.5% of this identified population, a ratio that plateaued from January onward despite continued growth in the caseload. These figures are consistent with international evidence showing that early warning systems can identify vulnerable students without necessarily reducing dropout rates unless they are embedded within broader, well-resourced prevention strategies (Haimovich et al., 2021).

IV. Profile ~ 785 words

FRANCE

EARLY SCHOOL LEAVING PREVENTION

1. Terminology

In France, the term *décrochage scolaire* (school dropout) refers to young people who leave the initial education system without having obtained a qualification at least equivalent to the CAP (Certificat d'aptitude professionnelle) or BEP (Brevet d'études professionnelles), corresponding to ISCED Level 3 (vocational). This national definition is broadly consistent with the European indicator of 'early leavers from education and training' (ELET), which measures the share of 18–24-year-olds who are not in any formal or non-formal education or training and hold at most a lower secondary qualification. The term *sortant précoce* (early leaver) is also used in French official statistics and corresponds directly to the Eurostat ELET measure. Young people between 16 and 18 years of age who have left or interrupted their education without a solution are referred to as *jeunes sans solution*, a specific administrative category triggering mandatory referral under French law.

2. Legal and institutional framework

France's framework for dropout prevention combines legal obligations with multi-actor institutional arrangements. The Code de l'éducation (Articles L.114-1 and R.114-1 to R.114-7) establishes a compulsory participation requirement for all young people aged 16 to 18, obliging them to be engaged in education, training, employment or an alternative qualifying pathway. The right to continue or return to education up to a qualifying level (at least Level 3 RNCP) is guaranteed under Article L.122-2, with complementary provisions for extended training periods (Articles D.122-3 et seq.). At the national level, the Ministère de l'Éducation Nationale coordinates dropout prevention through the MLDS (Mission de Lutte contre le Décrochage Scolaire), embedded within school networks. Territorial coordination is organized through the PSAD (Plateformes de Suivi et d'Appui aux Décrocheurs), which bring together the education authority (rectorat/DSDEN), regional councils, Missions Locales, and employment services to ensure that identified young people without a solution are contacted and referred to an appropriate pathway. The SIEI (Système Interministériel d'Échange d'Informations) provides the inter-ministerial data infrastructure enabling systematic identification of young people who have exited education without qualification.

3. Identification and early warning mechanisms

Dropout prevention in France operates on a dual model combining prevention within schools and remediation for those who have already left. Within schools, Groupes de Prévention du Décrochage Scolaire (GPDS) are responsible for early identification, drawing on administrative data including attendance records, academic progression and behavioral indicators. At the territorial level, the SIEI enables systematic cross-referencing of education and training records to identify 16–18-year-olds who are no longer enrolled and have not obtained a qualification. Campaigns are conducted by PSAD platforms, coordinating outreach and referral. Monthly tracking data from the Gironde département (2024–25) illustrate the operational dynamics of this system: the active identified caseload grew from 3,874 in September 2024 to 4,542 by June 2025, with new monthly detections declining sharply after October — from 1,446 newly identified cases to fewer than 150 by June — as the residual caseload converged toward a persistent group of complex cases with a monthly exit rate below 1% (MLDS/DSDEN 33, 2025).

4. Second-chance and re-entry provisions

Young people identified as being without a solution are offered a range of re-entry pathways through the FOQUALE network (Formation Qualification Emploi), which pools available dispositifs from the Éducation

Nationale including: Pôles Relais Insertion (PRI, operated by MLDS for 16–18-year-olds without a solution); microlycées (small-scale flexible upper secondary units for older students); dispositifs passerelles; and modular qualification routes for partial CAP or BEP completion. Missions Locales play a central role in supporting the 16–25 age group through personalised guidance, employment support and referral to training. Apprenticeship and alternance routes provide an additional re-entry pathway, particularly relevant for vocational track students. The effectiveness of these pathways depends on available capacity, territorial coordination and the quality of referral chains from identification to actual placement in a solution.

5. Monitoring and data availability

The main national indicator for tracking early school leaving is the sortants précoces rate, calculated by INSEE from the Enquête Emploi (Labour Force Survey) and aligned with the Eurostat ELET methodology. France reported a rate of 7.6% in 2023 (DEPP/INSEE, 2024), below the EU average of 9.4% (Eurostat, 2024) and meeting the French national target of 9.5%. Operational tracking of the identified dropout population is managed through monthly SIEI-based campaigns coordinated by PSAD platforms, generating data on the number of young people identified, contacted and offered a solution. These data are disaggregated by sex, establishment type (MEN/Agriculture) and, in some contexts, qualification level. However, systematic national reporting of re-engagement outcomes and solution uptake rates remains limited. A continuity-of-follow-up indicator — measuring the proportion of the active identified caseload comprising young people already known from a prior tracking period — can be derived from monthly SIEI aggregates and provides an infra-annual measure of system persistence and case complexity (Martin-Gomez, 2025).

V. Analytical Box · Crosswalk

BOX · Aligning national dropout prevention frameworks with SDG 4 — the case of France ~ 338 words

Preventing early school leaving is closely linked to SDG 4 commitments on completion, equity and learning pathways. International frameworks increasingly stress that reducing dropout requires not only access to education, but also continuity of participation, flexible re-entry options and coordinated support for adolescents at risk of exclusion (UNESCO, 2015; UNICEF, 2018).

In France, this perspective is reflected in a relatively comprehensive legal and institutional framework. National provisions combine compulsory engagement for 16–18-year-olds, the right to continue or return to education or training, lifelong guidance mechanisms, and referral protocols designed to ensure that young people identified as being without a solution are contacted and offered a pathway. Multi-actor arrangements — including territorial coordination platforms (PSAD), the MLDS and Missions Locales — are designed to connect education, social support and transition-to-employment functions.

The correspondence between this framework and SDG 4 targets is substantial. Compulsory participation provisions directly support SDG 4.1 (completion of secondary education); the right to return to a qualifying pathway maps onto SDG 4.3 (access to technical and vocational education and training); gender-disaggregated monitoring responds to SDG 4.5 (parity); and the PSAD referral architecture addresses SDG 4.a obligations on inclusive systems. At the same time, the framework resonates with SDG 8.6 imperatives to reduce the share of youth not in employment, education or training.

From an international monitoring perspective, the main issue is not policy alignment but implementation capacity. The existence of legal guarantees does not in itself ensure sustained

participation or qualification attainment. Their effectiveness depends on timely identification, clear institutional responsibilities, functioning referral chains and the availability of consistent monitoring indicators — including the share of young people without a solution, re-engagement rates and transitions back into education or training. The French case illustrates a broader lesson for global monitoring: compliance with international commitments is best assessed not only through legal provisions, but through the extent to which systems can translate rights and coordination mechanisms into measurable continuity of learning pathways.

Table 1. French legal provisions for dropout prevention and their alignment with international frameworks (SDG 4 / UNESCO / UNICEF)

French Provision	What It Requires / Aims to Achieve	UN / UNESCO / UNICEF Framework	Key Monitoring Indicators
Compulsory training (16–18) Art. L.114-1 ; R.114-1–7	Ensure every 16–18-year-old is engaged in a pathway (education, training, employment, apprenticeship) and followed up by a Local Mission.	SDG 4.1 (completion, equity); UNICEF (continuity of adolescent pathways); UNESCO Education 2030 (lifelong learning).	Share of 16–18 without a solution; time to first contact; re-engagement rate; coordination evidence (Local Mission / authorities).
Right to continue / complete to RNCP Level 3 Art. L.122-2	Duty to avoid leaving school unqualified; mechanisms to extend schooling/training; right to education protected (incl. parental opposition cases).	Rights-based approach; SDG 4.1 (completion, equity); UNICEF (equity, inclusion).	Early leaver rate; RNCP Level 3 attainment rate; return-to-training uptake; barrier analysis (gender, SES, territory).
Additional qualifying training period (16–25) Art. D.122-3-1	Structured second-chance provision on request: additional period leading to a diploma, award or RNCP certificate.	UNESCO lifelong learning (flexible pathways, second chances); SDG 4.3/4.4 (TVET, skills); RALE.	Places available (capacity); completion rate; qualification obtained; transition rate (training → employment / further study).
Lifelong guidance Art. L.313-7	Requirement to implement a guidance policy (information, counselling): structural dropout prevention through informed choices.	UNESCO Education 2030 (pathways, equity); UNICEF (skills + trajectories); SDG 4.	Access to guidance; counselling interviews conducted; satisfaction rates; reduction in involuntary guidance breaks.
Referral to a solution Art. L.313-8	'Identification → contact → offer' mechanism: contact details transmitted to ensure a solution is offered to every identified young person.	UNICEF (data & systems); UNESCO Education 2030 (steering/monitoring); SDG 4 (tracking inequalities).	Referral processing chain; GDPR-compliant data sharing; timelines; 'successful contact' rate; 'solution accepted' rate.
PSAD — Monitoring & support platforms Art. D.331-42	Multi-stakeholder territorial platform: case management, coordination, support (Education + Region + Local Missions + employment services).	SDG 17 (partnerships, enabling factor); UNICEF (intersectoral systems); UNESCO (multi-stakeholder governance).	Stakeholder mapping; referral protocol; COPIL activity; resolution indicators (stabilised pathways, solution uptake rate).
MLDS — Mission combating school dropout (Official Bulletin circular)	Core mandate: prevent dropout, facilitate access to a diploma/qualification, secure pathways, operationalise the right to return.	UNESCO Education 2030 (equity + second chance); UNICEF (out-of-school adolescents); SDG 4.	MLDS intervention typology (prevention / remediation); reach ratio (active caseload / identified); QA of pathways; harmonised reporting.
Right to return to initial education/training (16–25) (Official Bulletin circular)	Operationalises the right to return: duty to offer a solution on request for 16–25-year-olds.	UNESCO lifelong learning (flexibility, second chance); SDG 4.3/4.4; UNICEF (equity).	Request satisfaction rate; time to entry; solutions mobilised (SRE, micro-lycées, apprenticeship, etc.).

Prevention of school absenteeism (Official Bulletin circular)	'Early warning': response as close as possible to the learner, with coordinated school-level measures and family engagement.	UNICEF (prevention / exclusion, systems); UNESCO (quality / equity); SDG 4.1 (completion).	Chronic absenteeism rate; school-level action plans; family engagement actions; impact on dropout rates.
Local Missions — Social & professional integration Labour Code L.5314-2	Key actor for social/professional integration; coordination with compulsory training requirement; NEET situation management.	UNICEF (skills & transitions); UNESCO (TVET / skills); SDG 8.6 (NEET reduction); SDG 4.4.	Transition indicators; education–Local Mission partnership; access to qualifications / employment; post-exit follow-up rate.

Sources: Code de l'éducation ; Code du travail ; Official Bulletin (MEN) ; Legifrance.gouv.fr ; SDGs.un.org ; UNESDOC ; UNICEF Education Strategy 2019–2030.

Analytical note — Compliance vs implementation capacity ~133 words

The correspondence between France's framework and SDG 4 targets is substantial across all dimensions: compulsory participation (SDG 4.1), second-chance provision (SDG 4.3), qualification attainment (SDG 4.4), gender-disaggregated monitoring (SDG 4.5), and NEET reduction (SDG 8.6). However, three structural gaps limit effective implementation. First, monitoring indicators for several provisions — notably referral processing timelines and solution uptake rates — are not systematically collected at sub-national level. Second, MLDS staffing capacity has not kept pace with caseload growth: in Gironde (2024–25), active MLDS accompaniment reached only 3.5% of the identified caseload. Third, qualification-level disaggregation (Level V / below Level V) is available for MEN institutions only, limiting cross-ministerial comparability. Closing these gaps would materially strengthen France's ability to demonstrate compliance not just through legal provisions, but through measurable continuity of learning pathways.

VI. Methodological Box · Original indicator

BOX · The continuity-of-follow-up ratio: a monthly indicator of dropout system persistence ~342 words

Definition. The continuity-of-follow-up ratio (CFR) is defined as the proportion of the active identified dropout caseload in month N that comprises young people already recorded in the monitoring system in month N-1. Formally: $CFR_n = \text{Repérés}_{n-1} / \text{Stock}_{n-1}$, where Repérés_{n-1} denotes the number of young people from the prior-month caseload still present in the current month's tracking system, and Stock_{n-1} is the total prior-month caseload.

Derivation. The CFR is derived from monthly SIEI-based administrative aggregates, which record both the total active caseload (Stock_n) and the volume of newly detected cases (Nouveaux_n). Since $\text{Stock}_n = \text{Repérés}_{n-1} + \text{Nouveaux}_n$, the count of carried-over cases is obtained by subtraction: $\text{Repérés}_{n-1} = \text{Stock}_n - \text{Nouveaux}_n$. No individual-level data or external denominators are required.

Interpretation. A high CFR indicates that the majority of the active caseload in any given month consists of young people already known to the system from a prior period — reflecting either sustained system tracking or a growing residual of unresolved complex cases. A declining CFR signals high turnover (fast natural resolution or re-enrolment); a rising or stabilising CFR near 1.0 signals caseload hardening. In Gironde (2024–25), the CFR rose from 0.75 in October 2024

to 0.99 in June 2025, consistent with progressive stratification of the caseload toward more persistent, complex profiles.

SDG relevance. The CFR complements existing SDG 4.1.2 completion rate data by providing an infra-annual, process-level measure of re-engagement system performance. It is particularly suited to low-resource monitoring contexts where individual-level tracking data are not available, as it requires only two monthly aggregate figures. It can be calculated at département, académie or national level from existing SIEI reporting infrastructure without additional data collection.

Limitations. The CFR does not distinguish between young people actively followed up and those passively retained in the database; nor does it capture solution quality or sustainability. Seasonal effects (notably the September re-enrolment peak) require exclusion of the first month of the academic year from trend analysis. Cross-year comparability depends on consistency of SIEI campaign methodology.

VII. Supporting Data and Figures

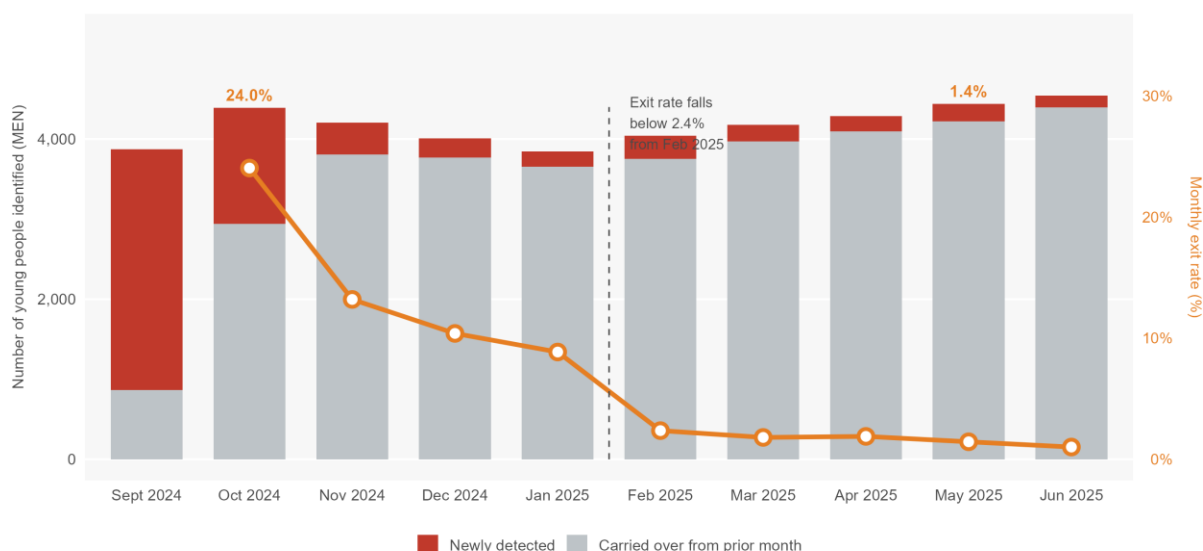
Monthly indicators — Gironde (MEN), academic year 2024–25

Month	Active stock	New detections	Exit rate	Continuity (CFR)	MLDS support	MLDS reach	Non-Lv V (%)	LP share (%)
Sept 2024	3,874	3,008 ¹	—	—	69	1.8%	92.7%	44.6%
Oct 2024	4,389	1,446	24.0%	76.0%	117	2.7%	92.5%	48.5%
Nov 2024	4,207	397	13.2%	86.8%	127	3.0%	92.6%	50.3%
Dec 2024	4,010	240	10.4%	89.6%	132	3.3%	92.6%	52.1%
Jan 2025	3,844	189	8.9%	91.1%	133	3.5%	92.7%	53.5%
Feb 2025	4,042	289	2.4%	97.6%	133	3.3%	93.1%	53.1%
Mar 2025	4,177	208	1.8%	98.2%	134	3.2%	93.7%	52.9%
Apr 2025	4,286	188	1.9%	98.1%	145	3.4%	94.2%	56.6%
May 2025	4,440	216	1.4%	98.6%	153	3.4%	94.7%	51.4%
Jun 2025	4,542	147	1.0%	99.0%	159	3.5%	95.3%	50.9%

¹ September includes 866 carry-over cases from academic year 2023–24. CFR = continuity-of-follow-up ratio (Repérés N-1 / Stock N-1). Trend indicators exclude September.

Figure A — Active dropout caseload and monthly exit rate**FIGURE A**

Active dropout caseload and monthly exit rate — Gironde (MEN), 2024–25
 Number of young people (bars, left axis) and exit rate % (line, right axis)



Source: MLDS administrative tracking data, DSDEN 33 — academic year 2024–25 (MEN institutions only).

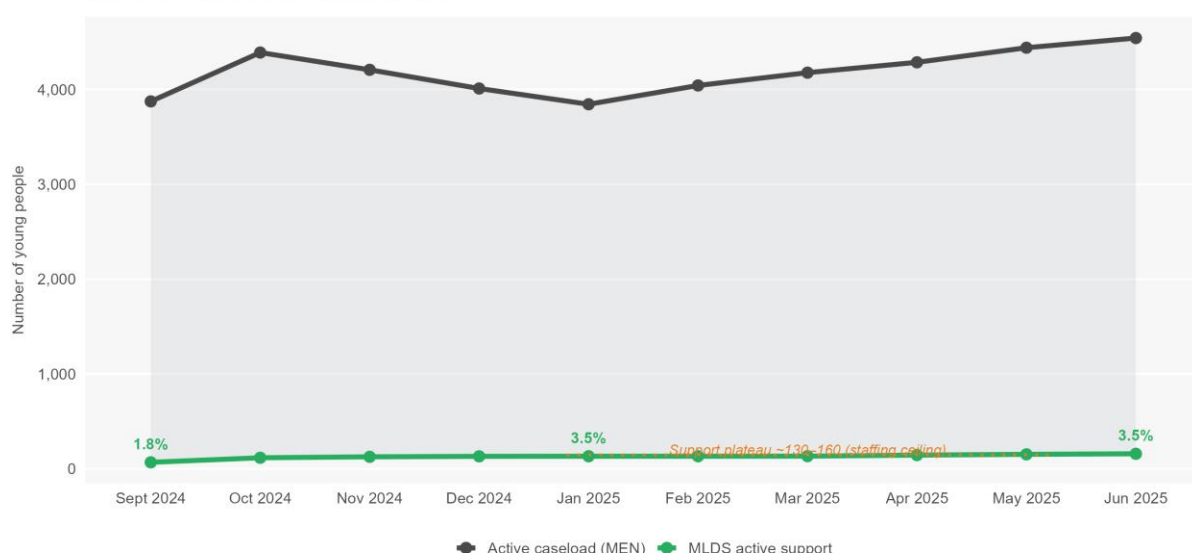
Note: September data included for context; trend analysis (exit rate) covers October 2024 – June 2025. September carry-over: 866 cases from academic year 2023–24.

Active dropout caseload and monthly exit rate — Gironde (MEN), 2024–25

Number of young people (bars, left axis) and monthly exit rate % (line, right axis). Red: newly detected; grey: carried over from prior month. Source: MLDS administrative tracking data, DSDEN 33 — academic year 2024–25 (MEN only).

Figure B — Gap between identified caseload and MLDS support**FIGURE B**

Gap between identified dropout caseload and active MLDS support — Gironde (MEN), 2024–25
 MLDS reach (%) shown at selected time points



Source: MLDS administrative tracking data, DSDEN 33 — academic year 2024–25 (MEN institutions only).

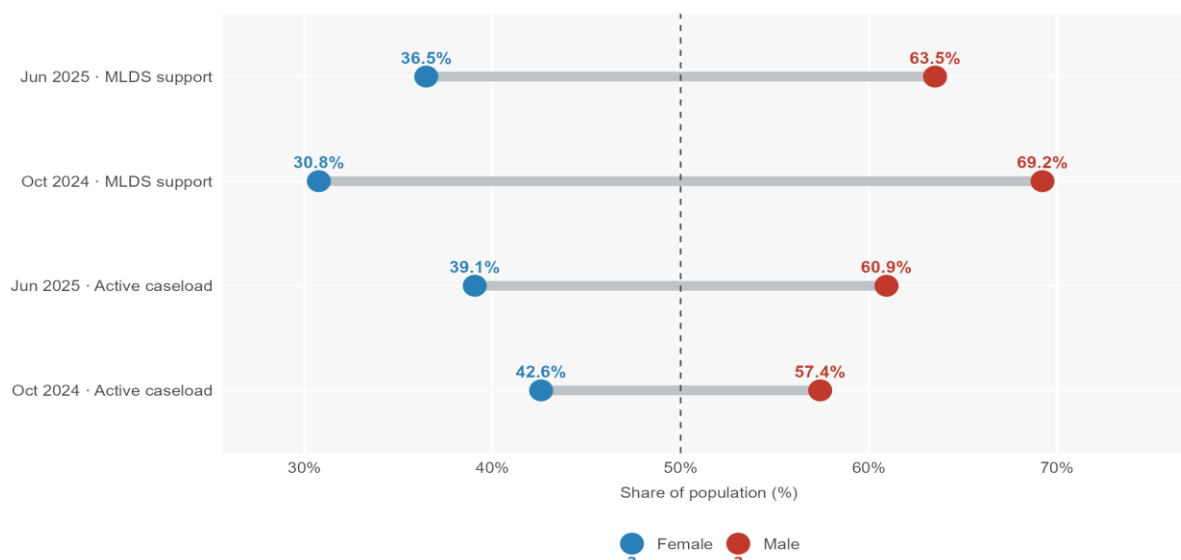
Note: MLDS figures represent active caseload (stock), not new intakes per month.

Gap between identified dropout caseload and active MLDS support — Gironde (MEN), 2024–25

Grey ribbon illustrates the intervention gap. MLDS reach (%) shown at September 2024, January and June 2025. Source: MLDS administrative tracking data, DSDEN 33 — academic year 2024–25 (MEN only).

Figure C — Gender composition: stock vs MLDS**FIGURE C**

Gender composition of active caseload vs MLDS support — October 2024 and June 2025 (MEN)
 Male over-representation consistent with EU patterns (Eurostat, 2024)



Source: MLDS administrative tracking data, DSDEN 33 — academic year 2024–25 (MEN institutions only).
 Note: EU early school leaving rate 10.9% (male) vs 7.7% (female), Eurostat 2023.

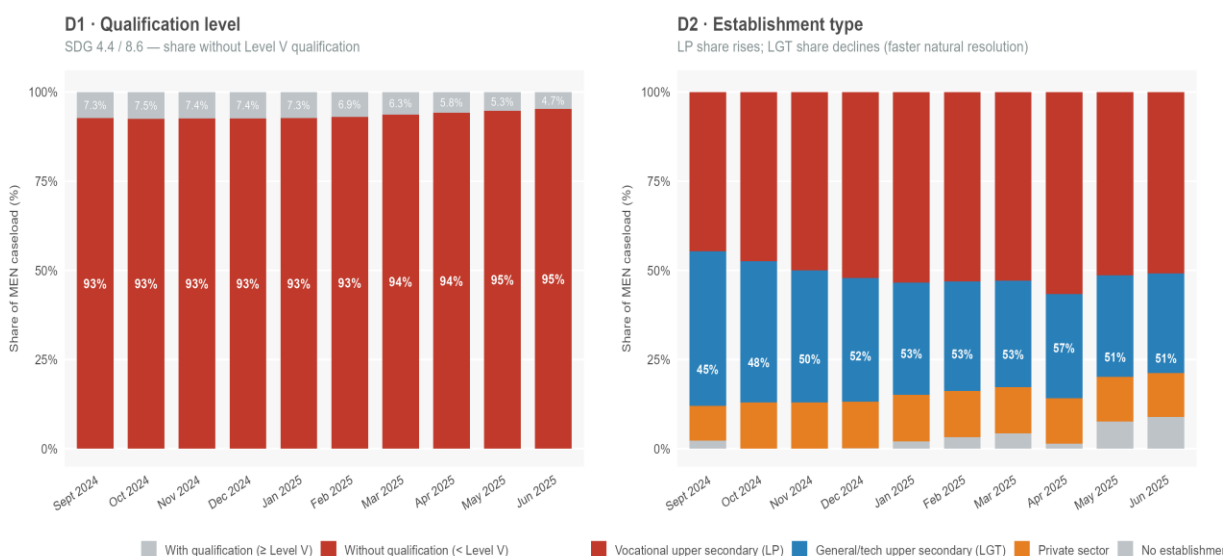
Gender composition of active caseload vs MLDS support — October 2024 and June 2025

Dumbbell chart showing male/female share in active stock (bottom) and MLDS support (top) at two time points.

Source: MLDS administrative tracking data, DSDEN 33. EU benchmark: 10.9% (male) vs 7.7% (female) early leaving rate, Eurostat 2023.

Figure D — Qualification level and establishment type**FIGURE D**

Qualification level and establishment profile — Gironde (MEN only), 2024–25



Source: MLDS administrative tracking data, DSDEN 33 — academic year 2024–25 (MEN institutions only; ~93% of full caseload).
 Note: 'No establishment on record' reflects cases where institutional affiliation is no longer tracked (students fully disengaged). LP = lycée professionnel; LGT = lycée général et technologique.
 SDG alignment: Level V threshold corresponds to SDG 4.4 (skills for employment) and SDG 8.6 (NEET risk) frameworks.

Qualification level and establishment profile — Gironde (MEN only), 2024–25

D1 (left): share without Level V qualification, by month (SDG 4.4/8.6). D2 (right): establishment type composition, by month. Source: MLDS administrative tracking data, DSDEN 33 (MEN only). LP = lycée professionnel; LGT = lycée général et technologique.

VIII. SDG 4 Indicator Mapping

SDG 4.1.2	Completion rate (upper secondary) — proxy: active non-completion caseload, monthly tracking
SDG 4.3	Access to TVET and flexible pathways — second-chance provisions (FOQUALE, MLDS, apprenticeship)
SDG 4.4	Skills for employment — 95.3% of June caseload without Level V qualification (CAP/BEP)
SDG 4.5	Gender parity — male over-representation in stock; female under-representation in MLDS support
SDG 8.6	NEET risk — persistent caseload (CFR → 99%) represents chronic NEET-risk population

How Gironde data map to SDG 4 monitoring

SDG 4.1.2 — Completion rate (upper secondary): The MEN active caseload of 4,542 in June 2025 (+17.2% year-on-year despite 2,652 exits) functions as a proxy non-completion flow indicator, consistent with the global slowdown in upper secondary completion rates (53% → 60%, 2015–2024, UN SDG Report 2024).

SDG 4.3 / 4.4: 95.3% of the June caseload had not attained Level V or above. This share increased from 92.5% in October as young people with partial qualifications resolved their situations earlier — a pattern consistent with the stratification of caseload complexity over the academic year.

SDG 4.5 — Gender parity: Males represent 60.9% of the active caseload (EU: 10.9% male vs 7.7% female ESL rate). Females are marginally under-represented in MLDS support (36.5% vs 39.1% of stock), raising questions about equal responsiveness of identification and support mechanisms across gender.

SDG 8.6 — NEET: Young people remaining in the system from February onward — approximately 3,800–4,200 monthly with exit rates below 2.4% — represent a persistent NEET-risk population. The CFR reaching 99% by June confirms that unresolved cases by mid-year are structurally unlikely to resolve without targeted intervention.

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Methodological note

Data source: Monthly administrative extracts from the MLDS (Mission de Lutte contre le Décrochage Scolaire) tracking system, Gironde département (DSDEN 33), academic year 2024–25. Data cover young people aged 16+ identified as having left initial education without a qualification, tracked monthly via the SIEI (Système Interministériel d'Échange d'Informations). Caseload includes students from both MEN (Ministère de l'Éducation Nationale, ~93%) and Agriculture ministry institutions (~7%).

Derived indicators: Exit rate = $(\text{stock } N-1 - \text{carryover } N) / \text{stock } N-1$. Continuity rate = $1 - \text{exit rate}$. MLDS reach = $\text{active MLDS accompaniments} / \text{active stock}$. Trend analysis excludes September 2024 to avoid start-of-year re-enrolment artefacts; September data are used for baseline reference only.

Limitations: MLDS accompaniment figures reflect active caseload (stock), not new initiations. Data are aggregated at département level; establishment-level and individual-level analysis would require access to raw SIEI extracts. Qualification level disaggregation is available for MEN institutions only and is not available for Agriculture ministry institutions (~7% of the full caseload).